

RELATIONS WITH SCHOOL SUPPORT ORGANIZATIONS

A. Purpose.

This policy serves to delineate the relationship between School Support Organization activities (SSOs) versus LCPS Sponsored Activities. Loudoun County School Board encourages the establishment of SSOs that seek to advance programs that improve educational opportunities for all students consistent with state and federal law. The School Board requires that SSOs maintain a close relationship with the School Board, administration, and staff, and that they consider School Board and school policies when planning activities. The School Board endorses SSOs, including, but not limited to, Booster Clubs, PTAs, and PTOs, but recognizes that these organizations are independent and separate from school-sponsored entities.

B. Definitions.

1. School Support Organization. A school support organization is a parent teacher association, booster club, alumni group, foundation, or any other nongovernmental organization or group of persons whose primary purpose is to support an individual school, a group of schools, a school club, or any of a school's academic, athletic, arts or social activities.

2. LCPS Sponsored Activities. LCPS sponsored activities are activities or events planned, organized, controlled, supervised, and supported by Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) and/or a particular LCPS school.

3. School-Support Organization Sponsored Activities. SSO-sponsored activities are activities or events planned, organized, controlled, and supervised by an SSO.

C. General Guidelines.

1. LCPS Sponsored Activities.

- a. LCPS sponsored activities must be pre-approved by the school's principal, no matter the location of the activity.
- b. Revenue from LCPS sponsored activities must be deposited into the School Activity Fund.
- c. Any activity for which LCPS provides direct payment to an employee (e.g., a stipend) is an LCPS sponsored activity.

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2. School Support Organization Sponsored Activities.

- a. SSOs are recognized and approved by the school principal to provide leadership and resource support to students and staff at the identified school.
- b. SSOs are groups formally organized as legal entities and operate with their federal identification number issued by the Internal Revenue Service. They must adopt bylaws that allow for the election of officers and operational procedures, receive a determination letter from the IRS recognizing the entity as a tax-exempt organization, and maintain required tax filings.
- c. The school principal may sever a relationship with an SSO at any time, and the School Board will be notified.
- d. SSO-sponsored activities held on school property must be pre-approved by the school's principal
- e. Revenue from SSO-sponsored activities must be deposited into the SSO bank account and must remain separate from school activity funds. SSOs may make a donation to the school following completion of the activity.
- f. When an LCPS employee serves as a chaperone or supervises an SSO-sponsored field trip or activity during an assigned/contracted workday, they must take appropriate personal leave in accordance with policy.

Adopted: 3/22/22

Revised: 10/22/24

Legal Refs.: Code of Virginia, 1950, as amended, §§ [22.1-70](#), [22.1-78](#),
[22.1-253.13:7.C.4](#)

Cross Refs: [Policy 2510](#), School - Community Communications and Community Involvement; [Policy 4320](#), Methods of Procurement; [Policy 8350](#), Student Activities; [Policy 7520](#), Non-School Employment; [Policy 7522](#), Absence Without Approved Leave; [Policy 7712](#), Sick Leave